



SURVEY SHARK

Researcher Admin Guide

For the researcher managing fieldwork and data

Covers logging in, preparing for fieldwork, monitoring students, and exporting data.
Your login password and web address are provided to you separately — keep them private.

1. What the admin dashboard does

The admin dashboard is where you manage data collection for your survey(s): control which student IDs are accepted, watch progress toward your response target in real time, and export the data you've collected as a spreadsheet at any point — including partway through fieldwork.

You don't need to do anything for responses to arrive

Every response a student submits (including ones that were saved offline and synced later) appears in the dashboard automatically. There is nothing to import or trigger manually.

2. Logging in

- 1 Go to the admin web address you were given (it ends in **/admin/login**).
- 2 Enter your password and tap **Sign in**.
- 3 You'll stay signed in on that device/browser for about two weeks, or until you tap **Sign out**.

Keep your password private

This password is the only thing protecting your response data and dashboard from outside access. Don't share it with students — they only ever need the separate, low-security “access code” described in their own guide. If you suspect it's been seen by someone else, ask whoever set up the platform to change it.

3. Preparing for fieldwork

Before your students start collecting data:

- Give every student the collection web address and the shared **access code** for the survey.
- Give every student their own **Student Researcher ID** (this is how their responses are attributed to them for progress tracking).

- Optionally, load a roster of valid Student Researcher IDs into the dashboard (see below) so only your students can use the app.

Loading the student roster (optional)

By default, the app accepts any Student Researcher ID, which lets fieldwork start immediately. If you want to restrict access to your class only:

- 1 On the dashboard, find the **Student roster** section.
- 2 Paste one Student Researcher ID per line into the box (e.g. one per student, matching exactly what you gave them).
- 3 Tap **Save roster**. From then on, only IDs on this list will be accepted — anyone else sees “Student researcher ID not recognised.”
- 4 To go back to accepting any ID, tap **Clear roster**.

4. Monitoring fieldwork

The dashboard shows, updated live as responses come in:

- An **overall progress bar** toward your total target (student count × responses per student).
- Per-survey totals: how many **completed** responses and how many were **screened out** (participants who weren't eligible — this is expected and not a problem).
- A **per-student table**, sorted so students with the fewest responses appear first, with a “Target met” or “X to go” badge for each.

Students can also check their own count from their phone — a **My progress** link is always visible while they're collecting data, showing their own completed/screened-out totals and letting them re-open any of their own past responses to double-check what they recorded. This should cut down on “how many have I done?” questions during fieldwork.

A student shows 0 or fewer responses than expected

Most often this means their device hasn't had a chance to sync yet (they may still be in the field with no signal), or their Student Researcher ID doesn't exactly match what's on the roster / what you gave them. Ask them to check the sync status bar in their own app, or check spelling of their ID.

5. Exporting data

- 1 Find the survey in the **Surveys** section of the dashboard.
- 2 Tap **Export CSV**. A spreadsheet file downloads with one row per response.
- 3 Open it in Excel, Google Sheets, or import it into SPSS/R for analysis.

Each question becomes its own column (or several, for multi-select and matrix/Likert questions), labelled with the question code and text — for example, a “select all that apply” question produces one 1/0 column per option, ready for statistical analysis without further cleaning. A **Status** column marks whether

each row is a completed response or a screened-out attempt, so you can filter those out if your analysis should only include completed interviews.

Export as often as you like

Exporting doesn't remove or lock the data — you can re-export at any time during fieldwork to check progress or start preliminary analysis, and again at the end for your final dataset.

6. Adding a future survey

This platform was built so it can run more surveys later without being rebuilt from scratch. Adding a new survey is a small task for whoever set up the platform for you (it is not something you do from the dashboard itself) — send them the new questionnaire and they can add it, after which it appears as its own entry on this dashboard with its own export, automatically.

7. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Forgot your password	Ask whoever set up the platform to reset it for you — it's stored securely and can't be recovered by you directly.
Export file looks empty	Check you exported the right survey, and that fieldwork has actually started — an empty export usually just means no responses have synced yet.
A student can't get past the entry screen	Confirm they have the correct access code and that their exact Student Researcher ID is on your roster (if you've loaded one).
Numbers on the dashboard seem out of date	Responses only appear once a student's device has synced them, which needs that device to have internet at some point — refresh the page after checking with the student.